

June: PCI Is Introduced

Intel introduced the Peripheral Component Interconnect (PCI) local-bus standard for personal computer systems. It was made an Open Standard, allowing others to use it without royalties to Intel. It is a 32-bit bus, with an operating frequency of up to 33 MHz, and can support up to 10 devices. The maximum data transfer is 132 MBps. The specifications allowed for a maximum of four PCI expansion slots on a motherboard, since only four Interrupts could be allocated. PCI devices allowed automatic configuration at boot time. The PCI bus eventually replaced other buses, and is seen even today on motherboards.

June: Surfing Defined

Jean Armour Polly coined the term “surfing the Internet.” A librarian by profession, Polly wrote a paper under the same title discussing the implication of the Internet for librarians, which was published by the Minnesota university press. This was the first instance of the phrase being used in a publication. Polly authored six books under the series “Internet Kids & Family Yellow Pages,” which lists Web sites suitable for children, besides various articles on the subject of the suitability of internet for children. She runs a site, netmom.com, where she is involved in making the net safe for minors.

July: OpenGL API Released

Silicon Graphics and the OpenGL Architecture Review Board officially release the OpenGL 1.0 Specification. OpenGL is a graphics API used most popularly in game development. Unlike the other graphics API, DirectX, OpenGL is platform-independent. Popular OpenGL games include *Doom* and *Quake*.